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DAGBANE DICTIONARY

a	architecture	dr	item of dress	mt	mat
ag	agriculture	e	emotions	p	person
		ep	epithet		
ai	agricultural implement	f	fish	pd	personal decoration
an	ant	fa	farming		
ap	animal part	fo	food	pl	plant
		fr	fruit	po	pot
b	bird	g	grass	r	reptile, amphibian
bf	bodily fluid	ga	game	s	snake
bm	body mark, sore etc.	go	gourd	sh	shrub

bp	body part	gr	grasshopper	so	song
bs	basket	h	herb	t	tree
c	crop	hu	hunting equipment	ti	title
cl	climatic	i	insect	tm	temporal (adverbs)
co	colour	j	jewellery	to	tool
cr	crustacean	k	kinship	tp	tree part
d	disease, sickness	la	landscape	tr	traditional religion
da	domestic animal	ma	mammal	tx	textile
dc	dance	me	medicine	v	vine
dk	drink	mi	musical instrument	w	weaving
		mo	money	w	weather
				y	yam

Singular	pl./imprf	p/o/s	cl.	Definition	Comment
A					
a		pron.		personal pronoun, second person singular, nom. or obj. case. you.	A zumi. You did steal. O nyaŋ a. He defeated you.
a		excl.		an exclamation of excitement or surprise.	A! a paaina! You have arrived.]
aa		excl.		an exclamation of disgust or censure.	Aa! bozuŋu ka a niŋ lala? Ah! Why have you done this?
aakai		n.		disapproval	KO
aayi		excl.		no, wrong, that is not so	KO
abaa		excl.		expression showing disapproval	KO see abba
abada		adv.		never. (Used word final in negative sentence)	Lala ku niŋ, hali abada. That will never happen.] {Blair: ever, used after a negative sentence. (A)}
abba		excl.		an exclamation of disgust.	Abba, Chel vuri. For goodness' sake.] see abaa
abe		n.		palm nuts	KO
abe tia		n.	t	oil palm	KO
abinfuura		n.		balloon	(Hausa) KO
abirima		n.		state of collapse brought on by fear.	{Blair: a'berema }
aboboi		n.		plantain	
abuya		n.		friend	(Hausa 'female friend') KO
adaka	adakani	n.		box.	<Twi {Blair: pl., adakanema }
adakabila	ma	n.		ballot box	'small box' KO
adashi	adashine	n.		1. pledged amount	{Blair: pledge; also def 3}
	ma			2. the collected sum of pledges from the members of a society, distributed in an accepted order until all have shared	[Man su adashi goli ŋo ni. I received the pledge amount this month.]
				3. a greeting in acknowledgement of kindness.	
adiini		n.		religion	(Arabic via Hausa) KO
adiko	adikone	n.		bag or cloth in which travellers carry their kit.	
	ma				

Singular	pl./imprf	p/o/s	cl.	Definition	Comment
adiku		n.		bag, luggage	KO
adua		n.		prayer. prayers of intercession formal prayer ceremony	[O niɲ adua . He offered a prayer (as a Muslim priest). O suhi adua . He offered a prayer (as an individual supplicating).] (Arabic via Hausa)
adua		n.		pigeon-pea	< Hausa
adua		n.		<i>Cajanus cajan</i>	
afa	afanima	n.		1. Muslim priest	(<i>vide alfa</i>) Arabic via Hausa <i>mu'allifa</i>
				2. moths which swarm on animals' eyes, at dawn and dusk	
				3. pig (epithet).	
afi		n.		comb	KO
afu		n.		a disease of the eyelid.	
afua		n.		1. recovering from sickness	[O doro maa niɲ afua . He is recovering from illness
				2. health	[O nya afua . He has health, or, he has recovered.]
				3. easy, not difficult.	[Tuma maa mali afua . The work is easy, or, the work is not difficult.]
				4. reasonable or moderate in price	[Guli daa mali afua . The price of kola nuts is reasonable. Di daa niɲ afua . It is a moderate price.] {Blair: recovery from illness; health. 2. leisure}
afulo		excl.		exclamation to ward off witchcraft.	[Afulo! n daɲ a . The curse be on you. (lit. I am before you; I am free from your curses.)]
afulo		excl.		exclamation rejecting accusation.	[Afulo gba, n ku zu . Impossible, I will not steal.] {Blair: only def 1}
àgázéli		n.	cl	1. period of 10-20 days of sunshine immediately after the rains cease	
àgázéli		n.	d	2. fever contracted during this season.	
agba	agbanima	n.		cannon.	< Yoruba
agbaa	a	n.		noon, twelve o'clock; zenith	KO
agbadudu		n.		leaves of an edible shrub having light pink flowers, used in broth.	[ED saapiriwa . n. .] {Blair: leaves of an edible shrub, with light pink flowers, used in broth. (Yendi dialect. Tamale equivalent, saapirewa)}
ago	agonima	n.		velvet cloth	(shiny local material KO)
agogo	agogoni	n.		watch; clock. bicycle bell	<Yoruba via Hausa
agufu	ma				
	agufuni	n.		interpreter.	<Hausa
	ma				
ai		excl.		no.	
akabiya	akabiya	n.		disease that causes rough patches in the skin of hands or	[O mali akabiya . He has 'akabiya.' - Akabiya sabilli
	nima				

Singular	pl./imprf	p/o/s	cl.	Definition	Comment
				feet.	bee akabiya pielli? Black patches or white patches?] {Blair: white patches in the skin accompanied by itching; not sores}
akarma		n.		drummer	(of talking drums)
aku		excl.		an exclamation of amusement, astonishment, or mocking.	[Aku! Gbonalana di o ba yili. The regent has succeeded his father.
akunta		n.		accountant	<English
akutaku		excl.			[vide aku]
akpaaku		n.		dock ??	KO
akpayila		a.		cold, shivering	KO
alaamiisi		p.n.		Thursday	days of week are Hausa fr. KO Arabic
ala		int.		1. how much? 2. how many?	
alaafee	alafenim	n.		pineapple.	alaafee
alakli	alakya	n.		the last Wednesday in the month.	[it is thought to be a bad day, that no journey should be made on that day, and that no business will prove profitable if begun on that day.]
alaamu		n.		omen. (calamity KO)	[Usually considered a bad omen unless designated al amu suŋ , a good omen.]
alaha		n.		cheap price.	
alahali	alahalini	n.	y	red yam.	<Hausa
alahari		p.n.		Sunday.	(alahiri KO)
alahachi		n.		sin; an offence against God.	[vide, taali].
alahachilan	alahachi	n.		sinner.	
a	nima				
alahaziba		n.		1. wonder, amazement	[vide, alebo] [Yalli maa niŋ ma alahaziba. The matter amazes me.] [Motuka yiyirgu mali alahaziba pam. The aeroplane is very wonderful.]
(alahazibu KO)				2. unnatural event.	[Alaha vielli, good omen. Alaha bieyu, bad omen.]
alaha		n.		omen.	[O nya alaka pam. He has had much trouble.]
alaka		n.		1. trouble	[Be niŋ o alaka. They punished him.]
				2. punishment	<Hausa
				3. persecution/s (KO)	
alala		int.		how much for each?	[when quantities are on display.]
alali		n.		cowardice.	[O niŋ alali. He is cowardly.]
alali		a.		1. pure; real	[Doliŋo nyela anzinfā alali. This is real silver.] [O bi alali. His legitimate child. <Arabic
Alamihi		p.n.		2. lawful; legitimate. Thursday.	[dialect, Alamsi] <Arabic

Singular	pl./imprf	p/o/s	cl.	Definition	Comment
alamyalam		excl.		an expression meaning ‘No one knows’.	[used by itself].
Alaraba		p.n.		Wednesday.	<Arabic(alaabu Alaarbu KO)
alacheyu	alacheri	n.	b	large bird which feeds principally on grasshoppers.	<Hausa
alC see also	aliC				
alcheba	alcheban ima	n.		cape with a hood.	
alchiidiri	alchiidiri nima	n.		bucket.	
Alchiyama		p.n.		the last day; the resurrection day; the judgement day	
alebo		n.		disgraceful act.	(something very little KO)
aleji		n.		palm kernel oil.	
aleefu		n.	c	‘spinach’ (a green vegetable)	KO
aleewa		n.		1. honey cooked until hard, cut in pieces and sold as a sweet football dribbling a trick.	< Hausa O niŋ ma aleewa. He played a trick on me.] < Hausa
alegeeta	algeetani ma	n.		shawm	
alehitama (?)		n.		doubtful.	[<i>vide behug</i>]
aleluyani		n.		Assemblies of God church	‘Halleluya!’ <i>ni</i> (at) KO
alfa	alfanima	n.		Muslim priest; one versed in the Koran.	[dialectal, see a’fa].
alfaani		n.		1. usefulness 2. grace; blessing.	[Di mali alfaani. It is useful.] [Naawuni ni niŋ alfaani niŋ a bihi ni. May God bless your children.]
alfoni	alfonnim a	n.		picture.	<Twi [anfon B.D.]
algaya		adv.		exceptionally.	Di viella algaya. It is exceptionally beautiful.
alhaji	alhajini ma	n.		a pilgrim who has been to Mecca.	<Hausa
aliC see also					
alC					
alibarika	alibarika nima	n.		1. blessing; grace 2. a word to mean ‘No thanks’ between buyer and seller 3. used in phrase ‘ Sha alibarika, ’ ‘thank you.’	Arabic via Hausa ‘Lower your price’/ ‘Raise your offer’ (T.N.)
aliba(sa)		n.		onion.	<Arabic via Hausa [<i>vide: gabanyuli.</i>]
alicheba		n.		cloak; coat	Arabic via Hausa ; <i>cf.</i> KO zabba
aligaaya		adv.		really	KO
aligusu		n.		1. fraud 2. treachery 3. mischief (when used of	[O niŋ ma aligusu. He defrauded me. O mali aligusu. He is a fraud <Hausa

Singular	pl./imprf	p/o/s	cl.	Definition	Comment
				actions of children).	
aliguufu		a.		little	KO
Aligbe		p.n.		Ewe	KO
aliheeri		n.		1. gift 2. kindness 3. idiom: d-aliheeri , with good.	(Usually used as a response to a statement, wishing one well). Arabic via Hausa 'reed' KO
alikaalimi		n.		pencil, pen	
alkalmi					
alikaule		n.		covenant, promise, bond, contract	closer to Ar. <i>al qawli</i> 'word' than < Hausa <i>alkawari</i> KO [see alk...]
alikota		n.		helicopter	<English KO
alikundon		n.		long cassock	KO
alingurma	alingur manima	n.		big horse.	[vide anga]
aliwalla		n.		ablution	(Hausa fr. Arabic) KO
aliwurti	aliwura	n.		joker; a comedian.	
alizama		n.		conversation.	[Di alizama . To converse.]
alizama		n.		conversation	Arabic via Hausa 'meeting, KO party'
alizanda		n.		heaven; paradise.	
alizimba		n.		Friday.	<Arabic (also alizimma KO)
alizini	alizinni ma	n.		1. spirit; genie 2. disposition or mood.	<Arabic[alizin'suŋ , good spirit; alizin'bieyu , evil spirit.] [N chaŋmi tu o d-alizin'suŋ . I met him in a good disposition. O d-alizin'bieyu n-yiysi . He is in a bad mood.]
alizimbieyu	alizimbieri	n.		evil spirit	aliziN- Arabic via Hausa 'Jinn' + DB <i>-bieyu</i> 'bad' KO
alkalami	alkalami nima	n.		pen, pencil or anything used for writing.	
alkali		n.		1. judge 2. soothsayer 3. a literate 4. Muslim priest.	Arabic via Hausa idiom: [Pah alkali ni Nawuni , to give up the ghost.]
alkauli		n.		1. promise 2. pledge 3. Lo alkauli , to promise, to pledge 4. Pali alkauli , to fulfil a promise or pledge.	
alkudon	alkudon nima	n.	tx	grey baft	
Alkuraan	Alkuraan nima	n.		the Koran.	<Arabic
alleeyi		n.	tp	palm-oil	
almaziri	almaziri nima	n.		a student of the Koran.	<Arabic
alobu	alobuni ma	n.		1. plague 2. epidemic 3. calamity KO	[aloba , ED] Hausa <i>annoba</i> fr. Arabic <i>al waba</i>
alobu		n.		good luck.	[A d-alobu na be nyaana .

Singular	pl./imprf	p/o/s	cl.	Definition	Comment
					Your good luck is still to come.]
alobulana	alobuni	n.		a lucky person.	
	ma				
alsahilana	alsahini	n.		joker; jester.	[dialectic, asa'hilana.]
	ma				
aluura		n.		reddish dye.	<Hausa
aluura	aluurani	n.		teak tree.	<Hausa
	ma				
alwalla		n.		ablution.	<Hausa
alziifu		n.		pocket	Arabic via Hausa <i>KO</i>
amaa		conj.		but	Arabic via Hausa
amaada		n.		the Sahara desert.	<Hausa <Arabic
amaana		n.		trusteeship; the holding or keeping or administering something for another.	[Niŋ amaana , to entrust; mali amaana , to break confidence, or to defraud.
amaana		n.		corruption (! - see above)	<i>KO</i>
amaŋka		n.		stretcher; type of carriage	Eng. 'hammock' <i>KO</i>
amashera		excl.		an expression of thanksgiving.	[N'a soha, amazara . Thank you for yesterday's favour (or hospitality).
ami		excl.		Amen.	
amii		part.		1. introductory particle meaning 'do you know?' used with double questions	[Amii a sa ni labna bieyu bee a ku labna? Do you know, will you return tomorrow, or will you not return?]
				2. introductory particle meaning 'no one knows,' or 'who knows whether?' [maybe; 'I wonder if ..' (tentative suggestion, request, proposal) <i>KO</i>]	[Amii n sa ni labna bee n ku labna? Who knows whether I will return or not?]
amiila	amiilani	n.		sword suspender made with wool yarn.	<Hausa
	ma				
amiinsi		n.		1. a secret agreement, covenant, contract.	[M min' o mali amiinsi . He and I have a secret agreement
				2. charity; good will	[O mali amiinsi ni nirba . He is a charitable person (a man of good will). [Arabic via Hausa 'trust(worthiness)']
amiliya		n.		1. bride	[Lo amiliya , to marry.]
				2. marriage.	(Muslim or Christian)
amilia	amilia	n.		bridesmaid.	
zozonima					
amilianima		n.pl.		attendants at a wedding.	
ampe		n.		children's game: played by young girls, kicking ball of leaves:	<Twi <i>KO</i>
amsa		n.		answer	<Hausa <i>KO</i>
anabi	anabini	n.		prophet.	Arabic via Hausa
	ma				
anabtali		a.		prophecy	- <i>tali</i> is abstract noun from noun derivation <i>KO</i>
anahi		num.		four	

Singular	pl./imprf	p/o/s	cl.	Definition	Comment
anashaara		n.		European	Arabic via Hausa <i>KO</i>
anchiti		n.		handkerchief	<i>KO</i>
anfaani		n.		benefit, dividend	Arabic via Hausa <i>KO</i>
aniini	aniinnim	n.		one tenth of a penny	West African English
	a				
aniwula	aniwuliy	excl.		a salutation as an evening greeting.	Gj.
	a				
ansarsi		n.		mockery; ridicule.	[mali ansarsi , to mock or ridicule (stronger term than ' ziem ').]
antire		n.		a salutation as a midday greeting.	
anu		num.		five.	
anuura		n.		1. worth; value 2. usefulness.	
anyangbana		n.		maize.	
anyibi		n.		1. unfaithfulness 2. untrustworthiness 3. mali anyibi , to be unfaithful or untrustworthy.	
anyoyti	anyoytin	n.		yam cultivar	[sangalnjo , WD]
	ima				
anzansi		n.		courage; persistence.	
anzinfa		n.		silver.	
angarma	angarma	n.		a big horse.	<Hausa [dialectic, alingarma .]
	nima				
ango	angonim	n.		bridegroom.	
	a				
ango zo	ango	n.		best man	
	zonima				
ankadi		n.		1. occult powers by which other powers may be bound 2. it may be used in binding the rain.	<Hausa [<i>vide</i> Kabre]
anko		n.		omen.	[anko vielli , good omen; anko bieyu , bad omen] [<i>vide</i> , alahe] [dialectic, hanko]
asaara		n.		loss; misfortune.	<Hausa [<i>vide</i> , ashaara]
asadachi		n.		dowry.	
asafi		n.		1. comical conduct 2. comical person.	
asafilana	asafinim	n.		comical person.	
	a				
asafihili		n.		comical conversation.	
asahi		n.		joke; jest.	[dialectic, alsahi]
asahilana	asahinim	n.		joker, jester.	[dialectic, alsahilana]
	a				
asama		n.		1. cheapness of price. 2. ease, i.e. without difficulty	[Di daa mali asama . The market price is cheap.] [Wor'bali mali asama n-gari bugbali . horse riding is easier than donkey riding.]
asanza	asanzani	n.		one with an exemplary character; a distinguished	
	ma				

Singular	pl./imprf	p/o/s	cl.	Definition	Comment
asiba		n.		person; a brave person.	
asibasi		n.		morning.	
asibirr		excl.		early morning.	
				imperative, introductory particle asking for attention.	[Asibirr! chel ka a wum di yelmanli. Silence! Wait until you hear the truth.]
asibiri		n.		Saturday.	<Arabic
asooma	asooman	n.		A plant with bulbous roots used in dying skins yellow, hence yellow colour.	
	ima				
ashaala		adv.		in reality, or not knowing (interchangeable with 'ashee')	[vide, inshaala] [N yeliya ni o zi ni ashaala o pun mi ni. I said that he did not know there, in reality, he already knew the place.
ashaara		n.		loss, misfortune.	<Hausa [dialectic, asa'ara]
ashee		excl.		equivalent to the English 'really,' 'in reality,' 'actually'	[Ashe'e! O kpiya? Really! Has he died? N yeliya ni a si ni ashee, o pun mi ni. I said that he did not know there, in reality, he already knew the place.
ashiloni		adv.		secretly.	
Ata		n.		name of an elder male twin; Ata'wa, a female.	
ata		num.		three.	
ataa		excl.		really; of a truth (in explaining facts).	[Ataadee, o daa ka n yiq' na, yuq. Of a truth, he came to my house at night.
atalata		n.		Tuesday.	
atam		n.		1. farm produce.	[O kohi i puu atam n-da nahu. He sold his farm produce and bought a cow
				2. rich soil	[Palo maa mali atam. The field has rich soil.
atani		n.		Monday.	<Arabic
achiika		excl.		meaning 'that is true.'	<Hausa
achiikatim		excl.		emphatic form of 'achiika', Verily, verily, in fact.	
atuzieyu	atuzieri	n.		shrub, the roots of which are used for medicine.	
awai		num.		nine.	
awuraba	awuraba	n.		educated woman.	
	nime				
ayaba		n.		plantain.	< Hausa
ayayoo		excl.		an expression used to arouse shame, (cried out with hands raised and fingers extended).	[Nyarimaṅa zuya, ayayoo! The self conceited one has stolen, oooooh!]
ayei		excl.		an expression of displeasure, regret or disappointment.	
ayi		num.		six.	
ayihali	ayigalini	n.		small seeds, imported from Nigeria, used for medicinal purposes. (seldom used in plural form).	
	ma				

Singular	pl./imprf	p/o/s	cl.	Definition	Comment
ayiinsi		n.		1. dishonesty	[O niɲ ma ayiinsi . He was dishonest with me.]
				2. unreliability.	
ayobu		num.		six.	
ayopoin		num.		seven.	
azaaba		n.		1. trouble	
				2. woe.	
azali		n.		1. fate	[O d-azali doro , his fated sickness.]
				2. beginning (when proceeded by ' tum ').	[Tum azali, nanyiya nye o . He was a thief from the beginning.]
azichi		n.		treasure; riches.	<Hausa
azichilana	azichini ma	n.		wealthy person.	
azua		n.		food.	[<i>vide, zuri</i>]
aʒi		n.		pilgrimage to Mecca	
aʒia	aʒianima	n.		1. female who goes on a pilgrimage to Mecca	
				2. belongings.	[O d-aʒia be n sani . His belongings are with me.]
B					
ba	banima	n.		1. father	
				2. title of respect.	
ba		pron.		personal pronoun, third person plural, objective case, them.	
ba	-ra	v.		1. to ride	[v.n babu or bali , riding.] be ba o bandi m' baya , I have taken my place on the seat of motor bike
				2. to mount a horse.	
				3. to shackle; to fetter.	[ba bandi , to shackle with leg irons]
				4. to peg put a skin for drying.	
				5. to perform a rite in the interest of another.	du ba 'dominate'
ba daaɲa		v.p.		to perform the rite to establish legitimacy	
ba ŋmani		v.p.		to perform a rite recognising a wife as a mother	
baa	bahi	n.		1. dog.	[male form: baaloyu .]
				2. low, marshy ground, swamp.	
baachali		n.		1. tale-bearing	
				2. gossiping.	
baai	baara	v.		1. to put up shoots	grow <i>KO</i>
				to take root	
				to revive (of plants)	o che ka baai m puhi vari , take root and shoot leaves
baa jila				to take root	
				2. to cease to rain.	saa baaya , it stopped raining.
				3. to unlock, (fettors, etc.)	come off the handle (e.g. hoe blades) <i>KO</i>